

the saints in Achaia”, and 1 Corinthians 1:2, “all who in every place”! In fact, as I have already suggested, it is probable that Paul sent out multiple copies of his letters.

John also is plain enough—Revelation 1:1-2. “Jesus Christ’s revelation, which God gave Him to show to His slaves—things that must occur shortly. And He communicated it, sending it by His angel to His slave John, who gave witness to the word of God, even the testimony of Jesus Christ—the things that He [Jesus] saw, both things that are and those that must happen after these.” That is how the book begins; and here is how it ends, 22:20: “He who testifies to these things says, ‘Yes, I am coming swiftly!’ Oh yes!! Come, Sovereign Jesus!” In other words, the whole book is what the glorified Christ is testifying, is revealing—as an eyewitness!! So then, the entire book is inspired.

And so is Peter plain. In 1 Peter 1:12,, he says with reference to the OT prophets, “It was revealed to them that they were not ministering these things to themselves, but to you; which things have now been announced to you by those who proclaimed the gospel to you, with the Holy Spirit sent from heaven.” Peter declares that various people, certainly including himself, proclaimed the Gospel, accompanied by the Holy Spirit. 1 Peter 1:23-25: “having been begotten again, not from a corruptible seed but an incorruptible, through the living Word of God that remains *valid* forever. For: “All flesh is as grass, and all man’s glory as flower of grass. The grass withers and its flower falls off, but the Lord’s word endures forever.” Now this is the good word that was proclaimed to you.” [He quoted Isaiah 40:6-8] They were regenerated by means of the Gospel of Jesus Christ, and that is found in the NT. Peter places NT material on the same level as the OT—it is the Word of God that endures forever. When Peter wrote, at least Mathew and Mark were already in circulation, and maybe Luke as well. 2 Peter 3:2 is to the same effect. Both Paul and Peter declare that a number of people were writing Scripture in their day.

I take it that in 1:3 Luke also claims divine inspiration; here are the first four verses:

Given that many have undertaken to set in order a narrative concerning those things that really did take place among us,¹ just as

¹ Upon reflection it seems obvious that anyone who knew how to write would likely jot down salient points about Jesus, but Luke affirms that there were ‘many’ who attempted a serious account. Such records may well have furnished material, presumably factual, for spurious ‘improvements’ added to the four inspired accounts in the early decades of copying.